

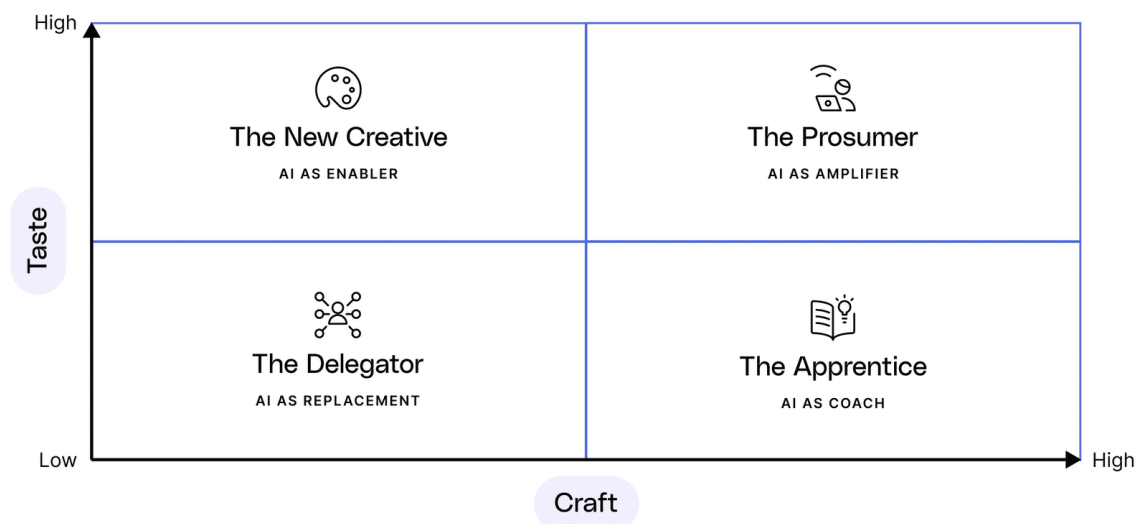
AI Design Consistency for the New Creative

The Problem: AI-generated projects suffer from "drift"—they are aesthetically inconsistent because each component is created in isolation, without retaining previous design decisions. This visual incoherence is glaringly obvious to experienced users who recognize it as an artificial look. They want seamless quality but lack a tool that can guide them.

The Gap: Current solutions either require manual input (like generating a DESIGN.md file) or rely on foundational screenshots (like Superdesign), failing to provide the effortless, comprehensive design guidance creators need.

Segment Profile

The New Creative (High Taste, Low Craft) — AI as Enabler



They're the fastest-growing builder population, and they *feel* the drift pain viscerally because their taste tells them something is wrong even when they can't diagnose it technically.

Who they are:

- Solopreneurs, indie hackers, non-technical founders
- Content creators building digital products (courses, newsletters, tools)
- Designers who can wireframe but can't code

- Writers and strategists who "vibe their way to a UI"
- Side-project builders who want their thing to look *them*

What they can do:

- Describe what they want in vivid natural language
- Recognize good design instantly ("that's not the right energy")
- Iterate quickly with AI tools (Cursor, Lovable, v0, Claude Code)
- Make taste-based decisions with confidence

What they can't do:

- Write a DTCG token schema
- Maintain a CLAUDE.md with design constraints
- Debug why three sections of the same page feel visually unrelated

Their relationship to AI:

AI is not a threat to their workflow — it *is* their workflow. Without AI, this product doesn't exist. With AI, they can ship things that would have required a developer six months ago. The problem is they've discovered a new failure mode they never had before: aesthetic drift at generation speed.

The JTBD

Functional Job

Ship a UI that feels consistent across every page, every session, every AI-assisted component — without needing to explain my aesthetic from scratch every time.

Sub-jobs:

- Lock down a color palette so the AI always uses the right ones
- Define a "feel" that persists beyond a single session
- Catch when a component doesn't match the rest of the system, without knowing what tokens are
- Be able to hand the product off (to a developer, a collaborator, or a different AI session) and have it stay recognizable

Social Job

Look like someone with intentional design sensibility, not someone who vibed their way to a UI.

The New Creative is acutely aware of the "AI-generated look", the generic sans-serif, the blue gradient, the shadow-heavy card. They have high taste precisely because they can identify that

look and hate it. Their product being visually incoherent doesn't just feel bad aesthetically — it signals to their audience that they didn't care. That's a social cost they feel deeply.

They want their product to look *authored*. Not designed by a system, but designed by a *person*.

Emotional Job

Trust that what I'm building has a coherent identity, that the thing I made last Tuesday still matches what I make today.

This is the deepest job and the least obvious. It's not about the output — it's about the *feeling* of creative control. The New Creative's greatest anxiety with AI generation isn't quality, it's **continuity**. Did the AI understand what I meant? Will tomorrow's session build something that belongs in the same world as today's?

When this job isn't done: they feel like a passenger in their own product. The AI is building, but it's not building *them*.

Competitive Analysis

Tier 1 – Direct competitors (same job, same output)

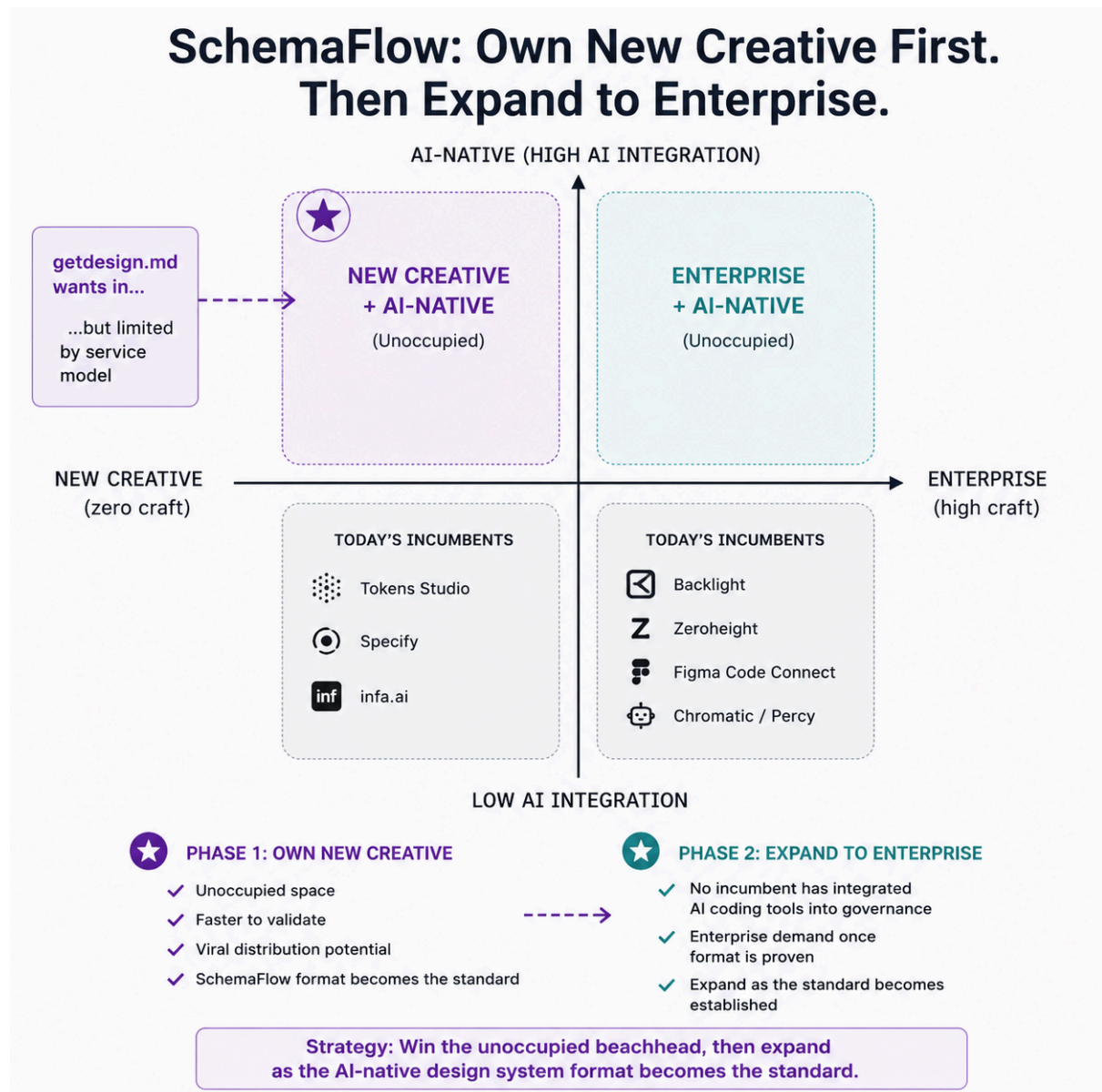
Product	Overlap	Why
getdesign.md	Very High	Extracts design system from existing site → AI-readable DESIGN.md. Same target user (solo AI builders), same format vision. Only competitor explicitly building the exact artifact SchemaFlow centers on.
Tokens Studio for Figma	High	#1 design token management plugin (264k Figma users). Manages W3C DTCG tokens, syncs with GitHub, enables theme switching. Largest incumbent in the token layer SchemaFlow operates in.
Specify	High	Design token engine — syncs tokens from Figma/Tokens Studio/JSON to code across 50+ platforms (CSS, Tailwind, React, Flutter). Overlaps on the token pipeline SchemaFlow intends to own.
Backlight	High	Full design system platform: tokens + components + docs + Figma sync + npm publishing. Most comprehensive competitor — code-centric, with bi-directional Figma sync and version control. It was shut down on June 1st 2025

Chromatic	High	Visual testing and review for Storybook. Catches UI drift via visual regression snapshots — alternative approach to the same problem (design inconsistency). Built on Storybook; strong for component-level teams.
infa.ai	High	"Visualize Design System in use" — monitors design system adoption and compliance across projects. Directly overlaps with SchemaFlow's enforcement/visibility goal.

Tier 2 — Adjacent tools (same workflow, partial overlap)

Product	Overlap	Why
Figma Code Connect	Medium-High	Maps Figma components to code components via CLI. Part of design-to-code consistency enforcement. Figma platform play — not a standalone product but builds Figma's moat.
Figma Dev Mode	Medium	Design-to-code handoff layer. Part of the same design system workflow. Positions Figma as the source of truth — if Figma wins, SchemaFlow needs to be compatible.
Zeroheight	Medium	Design system documentation platform (79% user satisfaction). Adjacent on design system management but focused on docs and human communication, not machine-readable enforcement.
Percy	Medium	Cross-browser visual regression testing (BrowserStack). Alternative drift detection approach

		— less Storybook-specific than Chromatic, more QA-oriented.
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The upper-left quadrant (New Creative + AI-native) is entirely unoccupied. getdesign.md is trying to enter it but is limited by a service model. The upper-right (Enterprise + AI-native) is also empty — no incumbent has built AI coding tool integration into enterprise design system governance. SchemaFlow can own the upper-left first (faster to validate, viral distribution potential) and expand upper-right as the format becomes standard.

Overall Industry Attractiveness: Medium — large market, growing fast due to AI, but highly fragmented with strong platform risk from Figma.

Key Dynamics: The market is splitting between Figma-centric visual tools and code-side enforcement tools, with a third emerging category (AI-native design context) that no incumbent owns yet. Chromatic and Percy own the "catch drift after it ships" layer. Tokens Studio and Specify own the "manage tokens in Figma" layer. No one owns the "AI builds consistently with your design system" layer. That gap is SchemaFlow's opening.

Competitor moats to be aware of:

- **Tokens Studio:** 264k user community; de facto standard in Figma ecosystem
- **getdesign.md:** DESIGN.md brand association; first-mover with solo builders
- **Chromatic:** Storybook integration depth; enterprise CI workflows
- **Figma:** Platform control — owns the design source of truth

Strategy Formulation

Core challenge

The design system tooling market has a structural gap that none of the incumbents are positioned to fill: all existing tools were built for human-to-human workflows (designer → developer handoff) and have not been redesigned for AI-to-AI workflows (design system → AI coding tool → generated UI). The fastest-growing segment of UI builders — solopreneurs and "New Creatives" using AI coding assistants — is explicitly excluded from enterprise-tier consistency features by every major player. Meanwhile, the problem they face (aesthetic drift at AI generation speed) is real, widespread, and unnamed — giving no incumbent a defensible position and no user a vocabulary to search for a solution.

Root cause

Existing design system tools were designed for teams who already have design systems and designers who can maintain them. They optimize for Figma-native workflows and developer handoff. The AI coding revolution created a new user class (high taste, zero craft) and a new failure mode (aesthetic drift at generation speed) that existing tools cannot address because they require technical authorship to set up and have no AI coding tool integration layer.

Rationale

The core market opportunity exists at the solo creator level. Currently, the sophisticated design tools that solve visual inconsistency are locked behind prohibitive enterprise-tier gating, effectively excluding individual designers and smaller teams from best-in-class solutions. This creates a critical void: there is no viable enforcement layer for independent creators. Furthermore, current competitive inputs are limited to screenshot extraction—a cumbersome process. We must therefore prioritize a natural language

approach that lowers the barrier to entry and provides true utility for solo users, unlocking a massive underserved market segment.

Overall Approach

Own the AI-era design governance layer by being the **format-first, AI-native design identity standard** — starting with the New Creative segment to build viral adoption and format legitimacy, then expanding to enterprise teams as the format becomes the de facto standard for AI-consistent design systems.